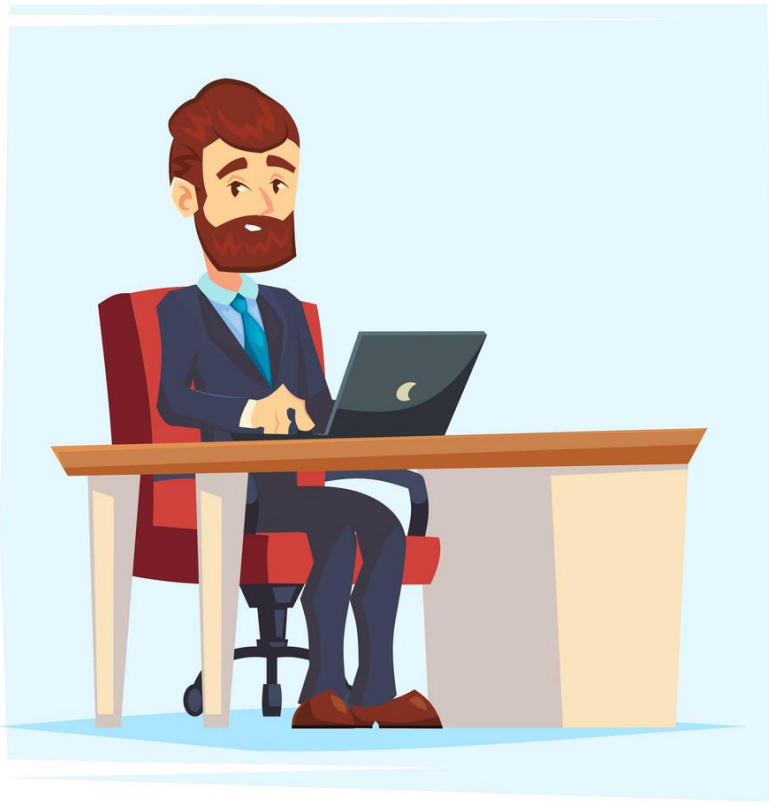




ETHICAL DILEMMA: Don't Ask, Don't Tell.

HUDA USMAN - VELIA PALMA - NISHA PATEL - AHMED ALGHAMDI

Case Study: Summary



**Dante McWaves,
Project Manager**

**Yvonne Moore –
Design Reviewer
from an
architecture firm**



**Bull Parker, Town
Commissioner**



**Reilly M Kraful –
Wastewater Process
Engineer**

Who are the stakeholders involved?

1. The company: Slud, Gefl, Owsdown & Hill (SGOH)
2. The town of Whiteside
3. Bull Parker, the town commissioner

Surrounding details that complicate this situation

- The apparent threat from the commissioner
- The fact the delay of the project will cause the town to be non-compliant with state regulations
- The Budget for the project will be overrun

Governing Laws

- National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) Code Section 820, which requires certain areas to be Class I, Division 1 or Class I, Division 2; i.e., “explosion proof.”



Who is Affected?

- The residents of the town Whiteside
- The budget of the town
- The employees and workers at the plant
- The company



What Should Reilly Do?

Alternative 1

- Comply with the code of ethics, Reilly should pursue his concerns until he feels the matter is satisfactorily addressed.
- Reilly has to do some research and have a qualified independent third party knowledgeable enough of the NFPA requirements to inspect the treatment room with him.
- Reilly should engineer appropriate solutions if his concerns were true.
- He should bill the inspection work to the project, even though it will result in a budget overrun but that is a small matter compared to the public safety and welfare



Alternative 1

Benefits

- Public safety is assured
- Research will make Reilly aware of the subject matter and he will be able to give better suggestions to the project manager
- Reilly will build his professional reputation on the merit of his service to the firm.

Consequences

- Cost of the project will be higher
- May caused a conflict between him and his direct manager Dante.
- He might not be assigned to future projects.



What Should Reilly Do?

Alternative 2

- Approach the source once Dante is in right state of mind.
- Share concern on the statement given by the fire code officials.
- Suggest visiting the fire code official together, to fix an appointment of visiting the treatment plant room and address their concerns
- This can clear the doubts like, has the official ever visited the treatment room or has mistaken it with some other treatment room to be explosion free.



Alternative 2

Benefits

- Public safety is assured
- Stronger relationship with the manager
- Reilly will build his professional reputation on the merit of his service to the firm.

Consequences

- Rise in the Project Cost and ultimately expensive for Whiteside town.
- Delaying of the Project
- Unsatisfactory Client

References

- "Code of Ethics." AIChE The Global Home of Chemical Engineers, November 2015.
- National Institute for Engineering Ethics (NIEE), Texas Tech University. "Case 1030: Don't Ask, Don't Tell..." *Murdough Center for Engineering Professionalism*.



Questions?